Exam Case

A patient comes into your pharmacy seeking for your advice. Your tasks are to provide appropriate information and advice to the patient

Time Frame: You have 7 minutes to complete this station

References: Champix (Varenicline tartrate) - CPhA Monograph

Name Mike Warner
Age 42
Address: 246 High Park Dr
Tel. 416-223-7737

New Rx; Varenicline 0.5 mg BID for 12 week
Day 1-3 0.5 mg daily
Day 4 -7 0.5 mg twice daily
Day 08 onward 0.5 mg twice daily.

Allergies: Not known
Current Medical conditions: Shortness of breath

Current Medications:
Salbutamol (Ventolin) HFA 1 – 2 Puffs PO Q4H prn

SP instructions:
•Opening statement :
•Hi. I am here to refill my prescription for Ventolin and may I know something about Varenicline (Champix) to quit smoking?

Congratulations! That is an excellent decision you have made. Decided to quit smoking. With this determination and proper use of medications, you will be able to quit smoking. Did your physician suggest you to do this? Yes
• Are you taking any other medication? Yeah Ventolin
• What medical conditions do you have? Shortness of breath
• How often do you use Ventolin puffer? These days I am using it more than the maximum recommended dose and that's why I am here for an early refill on Ventolin
• This seems like your shortness of breath is not well controlled? No
• Are you allergic to anything? No
•How many cigarettes do you smoke a day? Up to 20 per day
• Have you tried Nicotine Replacement Therapy before? Yes but with no success

5 minute question: How does Varenicline works?

Solved if:

- Counsel him on varenicline
- The patient sets a date to stop smoking. CHAMPIX dosing should start 1-2 Weeks before this date.
- To minimize nausea side effect start 0.5 mg daily dose for day 1-3 and 0.5 bid for day 4 to 8 and day 8 onward 0.5 mg twice daily.
- CHAMPIX should be taken after eating and with a full glass of water.

- **Ask him to consult the doctor to get a stronger corticosteroid to control shortness of breath.**

Marginally Solved

- Counsels patient on *varenicline* depending upon the number of cigarettes
- Does not refer him to the doctor for shortness of breath
- Does not properly explain the time – frame to start varenicline

Pharmacy PREP OSCE Check List Case # 6 (506)

Case Title. Varenicline

Communication skills (checklist)	**Acceptable 4/4**	**Marginally Acceptable (3/4)**	Marginally UNAcceptable 2/4	**NOT Acceptable 0-1/4**
Opening Statement (respond to patient clue, good listener, did not interrupt patient, engaging). Non-verbal Skills (eye contact, gesture, posture), Identified patient? **Congratulates him about quitting smoking**				
Information gathering process. (Asked M-A-M-A) allergies, medicine history, medical conditions. Builds trust and confidence with patient, Specific lifestyle such as caffeine, diet, exercise, alcohol and smoking habits (number of cigarettes/day); and/or other considerations relevant to the purpose of the case.				
Discuss Follow up/Monitoring relevant to case				
Time to check references, and use of proper references				
Overall time management				
Overall communications				

Problem Solving (checklist)	Fully solved (4/4	Marginally solved 3/4	Marginally unsolved 2/4	Unsolved (U) 0-1 /4
key elements of the counseling task 1) **Counselling about the Varenicline** (Rrecommended Dose and Dosage adjustments) **2) 5 minute question** (Mechanism of action: CHAMPIX can help to relieve the craving and withdrawal symptoms associated with stopping smoking. CHAMPIX does not contain nicotine, but it has been shown to affect the nicotine receptor in the brain that is thought to be most related to smoking addiction. CHAMPIX can affect this receptor in two opposite ways: it acts like a weaker version of nicotine, and also blocks nicotine from getting to the receptor because it binds more tightly) **3) Non – Pharms** (Start exercising, Stay away from smokers and places that you associate with smoking. If people close to you smoke, ask them to quit with you, Keep gum, hard candy, or something to put in your mouth handy. If you get a craving for a cigarette, try one of these instead, Don't give up, even if you start smoking again. It takes most people a few tries before they succeed) 4) **Refer patient to the doctor** (Ask the patient to see the doctor to get a stronger medication like corticosteroid inhaler for better management of shortness of breath and then set a quit date for smoking cessation)				